

CASE ID: 201610710317

EPISODE NAME: Dalai Lama visits Slovakia 2016

2016/10/17 - 2016/11/05

Sender: China (710)

Target: Slovakia (317)

Issue: Terminate Support of Non-State Actors (10)

Final Outcome: Stalemate After Sanctions Imposition (9)

Summary:

On 2016/01/17, China announced it would retaliate against Slovakia after President Andrej Kiska met with the Dalai Lama.¹ Beijing ultimately cancelled an important diplomatic meeting with Bratislava on 2016/11/05.²

Narrative:

On 2016/10/17, Slovakian president Andrej Kiska met with the Dalai Lama.³ Directly after the visit, Chinese foreign ministry spokeswoman Hua Chunying said that China would “make a corresponding response.”⁴ There are no reports of public threats prior to the spiritual leader’s visit.

On 2016/11/05, China canceled a diplomatic meeting with Slovakian prime minister Robert Fico.⁵ Fico alleged that Kiska’s meeting with the Dalai Lama had “clearly damaged Slovak-Chinese relations” and that it would set important economic projects tied to China behind.⁶ However, it is not clear that the meeting had any direct effects on bilateral relations.⁷

¹ Kroet, Cynthia. “Slovak president’s meeting with Dalai Lama angers China.” *Politico*, 17 Oct. 2017.

<https://www.politico.eu/article/slovak-presidents-meeting-with-dalai-lama-angers-china/>

² Agence France-Presse. “China cancels bilateral talks with Slovak prime minister.” *South China Morning Post*, 6 Nov. 2016.

<https://www.scmp.com/news/china/diplomacy-defence/article/2043497/china-cancels-bilateral-talks-slovak-prime-minister>

³ Kroet, Cynthia. “Slovak president’s meeting with Dalai Lama angers China.” *Politico*, 17 Oct. 2017.

<https://www.politico.eu/article/slovak-presidents-meeting-with-dalai-lama-angers-china/>

⁴ *Ibid.*

⁵ Agence France-Presse. “China cancels bilateral talks with Slovak prime minister.” *South China Morning Post*, 6 Nov. 2016.

<https://www.scmp.com/news/china/diplomacy-defence/article/2043497/china-cancels-bilateral-talks-slovak-prime-minister>

⁶ *Ibid.*

⁷ Šimalčík, Matej. “Slovakia: A New Challenger of China's Human Rights Record?” – *The Diplomat*. for The Diplomat, August 17, 2020.

<https://thediplomat.com/2020/08/slovakia-a-new-challenger-of-chinas-human-rights-record/>